

suitable. The additional words in the name provide more context and resolve ambiguity.

It's better to be overly descriptive than not descriptive enough. But there are guidelines for determining when longer names are unnecessary.

Prefixes in Names

The use of common prefixes in names could indicate unnecessary detail in the name. If a variable is an attribute of a class, the prefix might provide information that doesn't need to be in the variable name. For example, if you have a `cat` class with a `weight` attribute, it's obvious that `weight` refers to the cat's weight. So the name `catWeight` would be overly descriptive and unnecessarily long.

Similarly, an old and now obsolete practice is the use of *Hungarian notation*, the practice of including an abbreviation of the data type in names. For example, the name `strName` indicates that the variable contains a string value, and `iVacationDays` indicates that the variable contains an integer. Modern languages and IDEs can relay this data type information to the programmer without the need for these prefixes, making Hungarian notation an unnecessary practice today. If you find you're including the name of a data type in your names, consider removing it.

On the other hand, the `is` and `has` prefixes for variables that contain Boolean values, or functions and methods that return Boolean values, make those names more readable. Consider the following use of a variable named `is_vehicle` and a method named `has_key()`:

```
if item_under_repair.has_key('tires'):
    is_vehicle = True
```

The `has_key()` method and `is_vehicle` variable support a plain English reading of the code: “if the item under repair has a key named ‘tires,’ then it's true that the item is a vehicle.”

Similarly, adding units to your names can provide useful information. A `weight` variable that stores a floating-point value is ambiguous: is the weight in pounds, kilograms, or tons? This unit information isn't a data type, so including a prefix or suffix of `kg` or `lbs` or `tons` isn't the same as Hungarian